DDI Training Materials: A Metadata Management Training Resource

https://ddialliance.org/contact-us

DATA DOCUMENTATION INITIATIVE

What is DDI?

The **Data Documentation Initiative (DDI)** is an international standard for describing the data produced by surveys and other observational methods in the social, behavioral, economic, and health sciences. DDI is a free standard that can document and manage different stages in the research data lifecycle.

DDI is an open, non-proprietary standard and anyone can use it.

DDI helps people achieve FAIR (there are training materials on this topic!)

What can DDI provide for you?

Librarians

- Maintains standard vocabularies
- Provides a standard structure for metadata that accompanies a datasets

Managers

- Allows reuse of structured, standardized metadata, to reduce costs
- Supports partnerships with others for interoperability
- Enables search and discovery

Repositories

- Provides a foundation for data catalogs as it allows searching at both the study and variable levels
- Allows the streamlining of repositories workflows

Researchers

- Helps provide metadata mandated by funders in a well-documented structured way
- Allows researchers to make use of reports, displays, and tools that leverage the richness of the data e.g. catalogs, question banks, concordances, and interactive codebooks

Developers

- Optimizes machine-actionability and makes programming against the structure possible
- Can drive process, leading to greater efficiencies
- Can be used with relational databases to increase flexibility

DDI Training Materials are available!

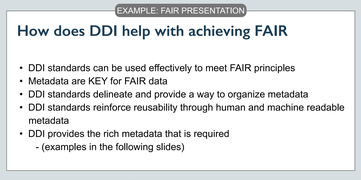
Our training materials provide an introduction to metadata and DDI, to those who are new to DDI — from the basics of 'What is Metadata?' to more detailed subjects like 'Variables and the Variable Cascade'.

The resources have been published in the Zenodo community DDI Training Materials in the form of presentations, and include a guide for how to use them.

The materials are mostly in English, but several have been translated into French, with plans to translate them into various languages.

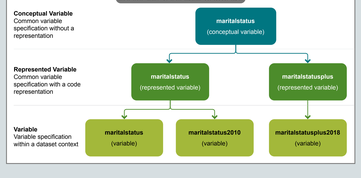
What do the Training Materials include?

EXAMPLE: FAIR PRESENTATION



EXAMPLE: DDI CODEBOOK

EXAMPLE: VARIABLE CASCADE



Broad / General

- How to Use the DDI Training Materials
- DDI Basics: What is Metadata? (also in French)
- DDI Basics: What is DDI? (also in French)
- Achieving FAIR with DDI DDI Codebook, DDI Lifecycle, and DDI Cross Domain Integration: Use Cases and Objectives

Broad / Specific

- DDI for Librarians, Archivists and Metadata Managers
- DDI for Researchers and (Meta)Data Managers

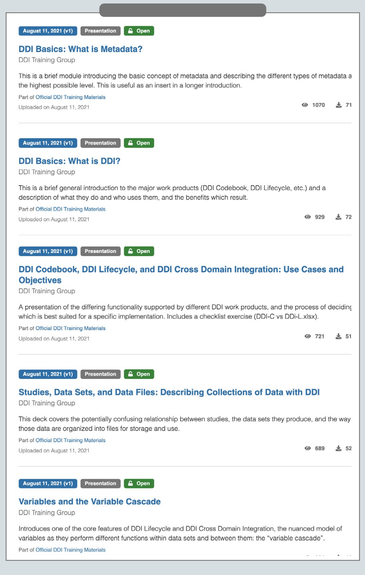
Detailed / General

- Studies, Data Sets, and Data Files: Describing Collections of Data with DDI
- Questions
- Representations – Codes and Categories
- Variables and the Variable Cascade
- DDI Identification and Versioning
- Foundational DDI Metadata: Unit, Unit Type, Universe, and Population
- Foundational DDI Metadata: Introduction to Concepts in DDI

Detailed / Specific

- Introducing Question and Instrument Structures

Training materials are added on an ongoing basis



START

Start using the training materials!

- For your own individual training to gain an understanding of different aspects of DDI
- Or when developing training activities

https://zenodo.org/communities/ddi_training_material/

Request Training!

If you are looking for training or other advice on understanding and implementing DDI specifications, we will connect you with people who can help.

https://ddialliance.org/learn/request-training

What is the DDI Alliance Training Working Group?

The training materials were developed by the DDI Alliance Training Working Group (TWG), whose mission involves introducing people to DDI and improving people's competence in working with DDI.

Join the working group!

- Networking opportunities
- Learn more about DDI
- Opportunities to conduct training
- Gain insights from others in different organizations and countries

Volunteer members of the DDI TWG meet monthly and are involved in Sub-Groups to put plans into actions. The current Training Sub-Groups are:

- Slide Deck Review Group
- Training Opportunities Group
- Training Requests Group
- Webinars Planning Group

If you are interested in joining the working group contact secretariat@ddialliance.org.

Get started with DDI today!

Scan the QR code for more DDI information and to find the training materials, request training and subscribe to the mailing list.

https://linktr.ee/DDItraining

Credits

- DDI Train the Trainer Workshop 2018
- DDI Training Working Group Members
- Authors: Hayley Mills (CLOSER), Kathryn Lavender (ICPSR), and Alina Danciu (SciencesPo)
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